Under the new laws, non-Muslims were expected to pay a total of four new taxes: land, house, pasture, and poll. Essentially, this meant that each non-Muslim male adult in the Sultanate was required to pay an annual fee for residing within the sultan's lands: for owning a house, for owning and tending pastures, and for owning any sort of lands. These measures were not only for financial reasons, though they served to vastly reduce the debts of the Sultanate; they were meant to effectively wear down the millions of Hindus in the land until the people were simply too impoverished to organize a rebellion.

Sultan Alauddin Khalji didn't stop at taxation reform. Next, he reorganized market laws that were meant to take effect throughout the Sultanate but possibly only were enforced in the capital. These changes included price fixes for basic goods like grain, animals, slaves, and textiles. In addition, hoarding was made illegal, and those found guilty of such were punished violently.

The more extreme of Alauddin's reforms—notably the market changes—were repealed by his successor, but his methods of extracting funds through taxation of the lower classes remained a keystone in the future administration of empires. In 1320, many of these taxes were still in place when Ghiyath al-Din Tughluq took his place as the first sultan of the Tughlaq Dynasty. Under Tughlaq's instruction, the Sultanate's military regime marched on, annexing almost every piece of the subcontinent except for the stubborn region around Kalinga.

Hungry for territory and ever-increasing power, Sultan Tughluq was renown as a hot-headed and vicious leader. He also had a lavish habit of expecting gifts from visitors, which he would return in kind. In this manner, a clever Moroccan traveler called Ibn Battuta secured for himself a furnished home, thousands of silver pieces of currency and a job collecting taxes from Hindu villages. In Battuta's memoirs, he noted the extremism to which his patron was inclined.

> Not a week passed without the spilling of much Muslim blood and the running of streams of gore before the entrance of his palace. This included cutting people in half, skinning them alive, chopping off heads and displaying them on poles as a warning to others, or having prisoners tossed about by elephants with swords attached to their tusks.